



Chinmaya International
Residential School
presents

e- Edition



It seems that the CIRS Students' editorial team is always eager to publish news at a pace faster than that at which news gets generated on campus! It was just the other day they asked me what I would like to convey on the occasion of the publication of their last newsletter. Yes, it is theirs! The students put together all the news items, edit the news and design the layout, with a minimal assistance and guidance from the teachers.

This e-newsletter is yet another initiative of our students to keep you abreast of the happenings in your school on a more regular basis. Please make it a point to read it. May I also urge you, if that has not been done already, to ensure that our children have perused the school magazine CHINMAYAM AWARENESS published by us in October 07?

Wishing each one of you the happiest of times with our children for the next month or so! Wishing you the very best for the NEW YEAR 2008!

Looking forward to seeing the children on the 5th January 2008!!

Anurag Sangal

1st December, 2007

Talks'

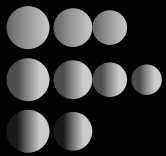
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Editor's Desk



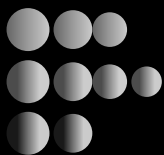
From the Editor's Desk

Hari Om,

As part of the new effort at keeping those who are outside of the school inside, the administrative faculty of the school drew up the idea of having an e-newsletter, along with the annual magazine and two-time-per-year newsletter. As part of our job on the Student Council, we were placed in charge of the school newsletter which was to be released monthly through email to our database of parents, Chinmaya schools, and Mission centers around the world. Not exactly as simple as it seems, we were faced with not only decisions of how to accurately present happenings in our school, but also decisions regarding design and even seemingly simple technological matters. However, the daunting task at hand did not dampen our enthusiasm to release a highly-valued end product. Our team really has given their best to this first edition, but we will continue to improve with each following edition. We encourage feedback, which is always a catalyst for improvement and growth. I sincerely hope you enjoy the material we have presented to you. We'll be back in January!

With regards,
Gautam RV Pathial, Shruti Kedia, Savi Kerkar, Vishwanth Kumar
The Cultural and Literary Secretaries
Chinmaya International Residential School





FEATURES

FEATURES

Assembly is the time which is interesting and without which no school can function properly. Our school assemblies are very interesting as the children are active members along with the teachers in conducting the assemblies.

Every week each house takes up the responsibility of conducting the assembly. Assembly activities are many in number. Our daily assemblies give each and every child a chance to show their talents. Here are some of the very good and speechless activities which took place in our assembly

- Student Talks:

- Ankit Motha gave a talk on a very interesting topic: student talk. He made us aware of how much effort and research a person has to undergo in order to make a worthwhile presentation.
- Kris Dandala provided an interesting insight into the basics of human psychology. He highlighted the important aspects of sour grape attitudes, the ugly duckling syndrome, and herd mentality.
- Srikant Singhvi explained the significance of the “Stand Up and Speak Out” program by the Art of Living Foundation a few days before event actually took place.

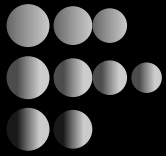
- Quiz:

All the information and topics are taken from the book 'AWAKENING INDIANS TO INDIA'

- The Vyasa house conducted a quiz on sports. The quiz was very interesting and we were not aware of so many facts before this quiz.
- The Viswamitra house presented a quiz on scientific facts. By the topic itself we can come to know scoring points in such a quiz is tough but now we were aware of so many things now.
- The Valmiki house presented a quiz on Yoga. By the topic itself we can come to know a lot about the ancient yogic practices and also about the different types of Asanas.

- Special Programs:

- Stand Up and Speak Out: This program was organized by the Art of Living Foundation, headed by Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, and was orchestrated globally by the Foundation on Wednesday, October 17th. The aim of this program is to spread awareness about the seriousness of poverty in today's world. In our school, this event was organized by the parent Sanjai Rao, and during our assembly time, we all “stood up” against poverty.



ANAND UTSAV

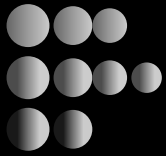


ANAND UTSAV

The 'Anand Utsav' - CIRS Family Meet 2007 was a grand celebration that captivated the parents, students and staff alike for three whole days. As the name suggests Anand Utsav is not just an event but one which is rejoiced amongst everyone. Though the three days were lined up with numerous activities and programmes, there was a sense of oneness amongst all. The preparations for Anand Utsav which had begun a month in advance gave fruitful results.

On the first day, 2nd Oct. 2007 parents arrived in the campus to witness the flag hoisting by the student council after which the exhibitions took place which were which involved the whole school. The exhibitions were unique in its own way and it enchanted the parents beyond their imagination. The day ended with an address to the parents by our Pujya Swami Swaroopanandaji.





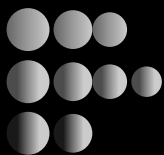
ANAND UTSAV



The second day which was eagerly awaited by the parents and equally dreaded by the students commenced with the parent teacher meeting. The day continued with the exhibitions. Later in the evening, the eagerly awaited event and the showcase of Anand Utsav took place. The Evening began with the Principal's talk followed by the prize distribution for the academic achievers of the year 2006-2007. The eagerly awaited school magazine, "CHMINMAYAM AWARENESS" was inaugurated by our dear Swamiji and Principal Sir. After this, Krishna's Butter Bash came to the limelight with our Pujya Swamiji presiding over the whole programme. The performance by our CIRS family, irrespective of age, was breathtaking. The day ended with the charity fete, i.e. the parents had to buy their own dinner which consisted of a sumptuous spread.

The last day commenced with the Matru-Pitru puja, which brought many parents to tears. This day also saw the conclusion of the parents-teachers meet followed by lunch. The Anand Utsav Family Meet ended with Valedictory by our Principal. As all good things come to an end, so did 'Anand Utsav 2007'. It was a grand showcase of the students' diverse talents, the staff's enthusiasm and the managements' unwavering commitment to student welfare.





NAVRATRI

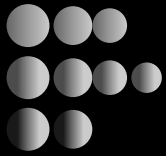


NAVRATRI

In CIRS, combining the religious and cultural activities, Navratri is one of the most popular and widely celebrated festivals of Northern India. With Garba, Dandiya Ras and worship of Goddess Durga, this festival unites everyone in one thread. Each day of Navratri is dedicated to one of the nine manifestations of the Divine Goddess. Navratri lasts for nine days with three days devoted to the worship of Goddess Durga, the Goddess of courage, Ma Lakshmi, the Goddess of Wealth and Ma Saraswati, the Goddess of Knowledge. Evenings are devoted to the religious aarti with the worship of Goddess Durga. Each day, students of different grades performed Pooja to Mother Durga and rejoiced with Bhajans in her praise. The first three days are devoted to Goddess Durga, and her different forms like Kumari, Parvati and Kali. These three manifestations represent the three different classes of womanhood that include the young girl and the mature woman. During Navratri the fourth to the sixth day is devoted to Goddess Laxmi who is the symbol of peace and prosperity.

The last three days of Navratri belongs to Goddess Saraswati who is worshipped to gain spiritual knowledge. Over these nine days we felt the importance of Shakti, “our mother”.





RAVAN DAHAN

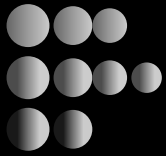


RAVAN DAHAN

The festival of Dussehra also known as Vijayadashami is one of the most widely celebrated festivals of India. According to Ramayana, Lord Rama performed the chandi puja. This puja was performed to seek the blessings of Goddess Durga for killing Ravana. Ravana was the ten headed demon king of Lanka who had abducted Lord Rama's wife Sita. Dussehra celebrates this winning of good over evil and the end of the kingdom of Lanka. Lord Rama, along with his younger brother Laxmana, successfully slayed demon Ravana and returned to his kingdom Ayodhya with his wife Sita. All over northern India this scene is enacted in the form of Ramlila with actors dressed as Rama and the others.

In CIRS we celebrated this day with the same joy and happiness with bhajans, durga aarti and towards the end, our students were graced by the holy presence of our own depiction of Lord Ram, Laxmana and Hanuman. They lead us through the path of truth, and burnt Ravana depicting "triumph over evil", followed by the distribution of Prasad. Lord Ram's presence was felt all over our school.





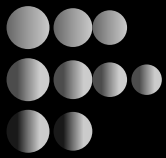
DANDIYA RAAS



DANDIYA RAAS

In CIRS, Dandiya Raas, along with Garba, was the featured dance of Navratri evening. Originated as devotional Garba dances, which were performed in Durga's honor, this dance form is actually the staging of a mock-fight between the Goddess and Mahishasura, the mighty demon-king, and is nicknamed "The Sword Dance". The sticks (*dandiyas*) of the dance represent the sword of Durga. The girls wore traditional dresses such as colorful embroidered ghagra and bandhani dupattas (traditional attire) dazzling with mirror work and light jewellery. The boys wore their traditional clothes. The dancers whirled and moved their feet and arms in a choreographed manner to the tune of the music. They rejoiced over the victory of Lord Ram and danced away into the night.





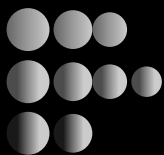
EDUCATIONAL TOUR



8th GRADE TOUR - KERALA : “GOD OWN’s COUNTRY”

The destination of the eighth grade tour was the state of Kerala. The first stop was at the campsite Kalypro, located in Munnar. The students visited a wildlife sanctuary where they encountered many animals like the deer, sambhar, and so on, but the most fascinating and rarest which they saw was the NILGIRI THAR, according to a majority of the students. Two of the twelve jeeps were lucky enough to spot a tiger. After this enjoyable trip through wilderness, the students headed out to Thekkady where they saw the awesome Kalari centre. Here, the students witnessed a show that displayed many martial art Techniques. The magical display of skill and swordsmanship was enough to keep the whole audience on the edge of their seats. After the show, the students visited a spice plantation. They experienced a heat unlike any other in the area. Then to cool off, they went boating for 6 to 7 hours on the backwaters of Kerala in beautiful house boats. The next visit was to the historical Kochi Fort. The fort was quite old and in many places was overgrown with moss. The students also visited the Dutch Palace, a palace that eventually got changed into a museum. One of the fascinating things over there was the Chinese fishing net! It was massive, hard and it was made of metal. After the visit, we were all really exhausted and we wanted a break. Thus, we were taken to Veega Land for very nice refreshment. Our last destination was Kumarakom. There we were taken to a bird sanctuary and an Elephant Fort, where we saw nearly 60 huge elephants chained together. Finally time came for us to say goodbye to our tour and now it was time to say “HOME SWEET HOME”. We returned to CIRS with a very rich experience.





EDUCATIONAL TOUR



9th GRADE TOUR : CAMP BAGEECHA

The 9th grade tour was a really an experiential one. We went to New Delhi by air and there we experienced the busy metro and we got the chance to visit the beautiful Gurudwara. From the Delhi station, we headed to Haldwani. We went to the Corbett National Park! The real tigers of Corbett could only be spotted by some of the students, and the others had to be satisfied with the so called “FRESH PUGMARKS!” Talking about freshness we also got a chance to take a dip in the Kosi River.



Next day we again were back to our jeeps to spot some tigers but this time we had to be satisfied with deer's only. We then headed to the most awaited part of our tour-“CAMP BAGEECHA”. We trekked up to a height of 2000m above sea level for a stretch of 2.5kms. After reaching the peak we were spellbound. It was beautiful and surrounded by rough and tough terrain, the marvelous snow-peaked Himalayas and a very interesting campsite to stay at, where we had to trek to the bathroom! The scenery was breath taking. That evening we got to discover the place and then wriggled in our sleeping bags at our tent after a bonfire. Next morning, we had an introductory session. Everyone was segregated into 6 various groups to make our stay more interesting and challenging.

We had to pick up any resources which we liked from the surroundings. Then we were told to make something out of it. Each group had many ideas and considering each ones idea and making a creative product out of it was quite challenging. Resource mapping was our next activity. Resource mapping is a tool which helps us to know the number of abundant and scarce resources in a particular area. We had to

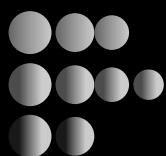


go to allotted villages and interact with the villagers to know about their resources. We then had to make a resource map and we would be graded on the accuracy of our maps and our creativity. We learnt about the villagers' resources and how to draw a map. We came to know about the resources but how many people use it, was the question?

Social mapping would answer this. Social mapping is another tool which tells us about the population of the area, the social status of men, women and children.

This time we went to another village and interacted. All the villagers were happy to tell us their life stories, their statuses. Most of the villagers we met were well off. They had a television, dish TV, bio-gas plant; etc. We concluded that most rural people are not poor, contrary to common misconception. We went to different villages and helped them in activities like peeling the shell off the rajma, separating the corn from the maize, collecting hay, cooking, etc. Then they in turn offered us ginger tea as temperatures went down to 10-15 degrees centigrade. We washed our own glasses with ash which is a very good cleansing detergent. Then we went to a small patch of rajma field where each group was given a patch of land to collect all the rajma fallen on the land and uproot all the weeds! Then we had to plough the field and then sow bajra seeds. We were given 2 hours of time. At the end of this activity the scores had to be given out of 20 but all the scores went into negatives! The highest was a '-137' points!!! These activities lead us to take an oath that “I SHALL NEVER WASTE EVEN ONE BEAN OF RAJMA”. Later, we trekked upto a height of 3000m to a Shiva mandir. From there we could see the beautiful Himalayan mountains at 180 °. It was as if we were all in heaven, it was indescribable!!! All good things come to an end and so did our tour. We came back to Coimbatore by train and had a lovely train ride.

This educational tour was really fascinating, interesting and a good way of learning



EDUCATIONAL TOUR



10th GRADE TOUR INDUSTRIAL VISIT: BANGALORE.

The 10th grade had a chance to visit the garden city of India, Bangalore, for their industrial visit. Though their tour was only for a short period of time, they probably were the batch who learned the most. They left the campus on 24th October via bus to their journey to Bangalore. After a long journey of 10 hours they finally reached their destination. They were enchanted by Bangalore's beauty and the serene lifestyle. After their tiring journey they halted at their temporary home, Basanth Residency.

On their first day, they left for their first industrial visit, C-DOT, Center for Development Of Telematics. This is one of the companies which have reduced the cost of incoming and outgoing calls. There they learnt how a telephone exchange works. They also learnt about the new developments in this field and about its outsourcing unit and its functioning.

Their next stop was MESUREMENT AND CONTROL PVT. LTD. There they learned facts about the upgrading of telephone technology. They were informed about the process which takes place from picking to receiving of the calls. They learned how signals were transmitted. Their day ended with a glamorous tour to the forum mall, where they enjoyed a lot

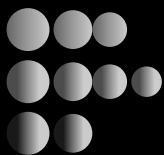


The next day they continued with their visit. The first stop for the day was at HI-CAL, High Caliber. This unit manufactures electronic equipments under the brand name of Kodak camera. There they saw the working unit and also how a camera works. They also learned that this company works as a family.

The last industry which was lined up for their tour was MANJUSHREE EXTRUSIONS PVT.LTD. Tired as they were they felt that they had seen enough, but they were wrong. In this industry they saw how PET bottles are made, how small bottles were converted to big ones, how different moulds give shapes to different kinds of bottles. The students were fascinated by the machinery and also by the amazing explanation about the industry given to them by Mr.Rajat Kedia, one of the directors there.

Finally with this industry their industrial visit ended. They ended their day with a visit to the Garuda mall. This tour would not have been possible without the co-operation and help of Vinita, Rachita and Sudarshan's parents who helped them through the tour.

On their last day they traveled back to CIRS via bus and thus, ended their journey. Though their tour ended their experience did not. They learnt a lot about the working of industries with the help of this tour.



EDUCATIONAL TOUR



11th GRADE TOUR : HIMALAYAS

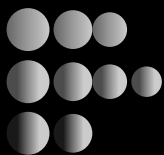
When one has been exposed to difficult living conditions, dangerous terrain, and harsh climatic conditions, and suddenly gets a strong dose of it over the course of two weeks, the burst is sure to be quite unforgettable. The 11th graders of CIRS got a chance to experience such a lifestyle during the last two weeks of October. The school assigned us an educational tour that consisted of five and a half days of arduous trekking up to 14,000 ft. high, river rafting on the rapids of the Ganga off the banks of Rishikesh, and other such adventurous and mind-numbing activities.

The journey began with the school departing from Coimbatore by plane and landing in Bangalore shortly after. From there, they flew to Delhi, where they stopped to have a look at the marvelous Akshardham temple, funded by the BAPS organization. After sincerely praying to the marble-sculpted deities in the architectural masterpiece, the students headed by bus to the Delhi train station, where we journeyed overnight by train to Uttarkashi. In Uttarkashi, we stayed in the serene Tapovanam Chinmayam ashram, where the Tapovan Kutir was originally located and impeccably maintained (in its original state). The ashram is run by Swami Dhyananda, who gave a warm welcome to the students and addressed them in the evening.

The next morning, the students were acquainted with their guides from the LEAP organization. After breakfast, the students packed their rucksacks as light as possible, and got in a bus to traverse to Haridwar. In Haridwar, they left the busses and almost immediately began trekking after receiving snacks and juice. With small breaks in between, the determined 11th graders, guided by the hands of the experienced LEAP people, trekked a distance of seven kilometers the first day, almost all of it uphill. They reached our first campsite of the trek towards the late afternoon. The LEAP people had already set up tents for the boys to stay, and there was a small, abandoned house with a room for the girls to sleep in. After dinner, a bonfire, and some fun, everyone hit the sack, anxious for tomorrow.

The following day arrived with double the trouble. Today, they had fourteen kilometers uphill to tackle. The next campsite would be at an elevation of 12,000 ft! With undying enthusiasm, however, they set forth and shortly after lunchtime, they achieved their goal and reached the next campsite. This time, everyone slept in tents. The next day was only a three kilometer trek, and they didn't have to carry their rucksacks, as they would be returning to the same campsite by lunchtime. The purpose of this trek was to get adjusted to the altitude and climate, for tomorrow we would be climbing to a point higher than 14,000 ft. After arriving back to camp, they enjoyed themselves until evening, and then went to sleep, preparing for the big trek tomorrow.

The next day, they almost immediately set out after breakfast. Again, not all of them were carrying rucksacks (one rucksack per pair of people), and they would be returning to the campsite again by lunch. After covering the distance they did yesterday, the students encountered a severely steep incline and had to struggle to proceed further. After much sweat and even more toil, they managed to reach the top. There, they were amply rewarded by seeing snow, and apparently forgetting their tiredness, they ran forward to play in the snow. After a good dose of fun, they rested for some time, and then headed back to the campsite. The descent was quick, but quite dangerous as well, with many loose and slippery rocks presenting quite a challenge. Thankfully, all reached their destination safely and ate a hot, sumptuous lunch. Their upward trek was over; now, only the downhill slope back home remained.



EDUCATIONAL TOUR

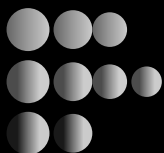


Arriving in a resort that looked like it belonged on a beach in Goa. Small, quaint little tents (with beds), located on a beach on the banks of the pristine Ganga made up the campsite. The campsite was owned by a company called Himalayan River Runners, and the students were introduced to their rafting guides. The next day would consist of exciting activities such as rafting on the roaring rapids of the river, rappelling down a mountain, and kayaking.

After spending the night in the beautiful campsite, the students awoke to face a day filled with exhilarating activities. Beginning with rafting, they traversed 7 kilometers over the river. Many rough rapid patches, each with a specific name, were encountered and quite a lot of fun was had. After reaching the campsite again, the students were split into three groups and all took turns participating in three different activities: kayaking, rappelling, and beach activities (volleyball, basketball, football). After this, the students had lunch, and then in the evening had dinner and a bonfire.

The next day consisted in 14 kilometers of rafting, and even bigger rapids. They eventually arrived at a small series of waterfalls. There, they jumped from a cliff over 8 meters high and landed in the water below. After the rafting was finished for the day, the students had lunch at the campsite, packed their bags, and set off for the return journey. On the way, they stopped to in Haridwar to see the Ganga Aarti. After this they went directly to the Haridwar railway station, where they took an overnight train to Delhi. From Delhi, they traveled by train for two days to reach Coimbatore.





IB FAREWELL & EXAM



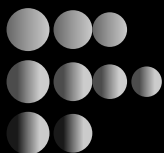
IB FAREWELL : “ TIME TO SAY GOOD BYE !!!”

On October 15, a farewell organized by the 11th graders was given to the second-year IB students, who had their final examinations coming up in November. The hosts were dressed as cowboys and cowgirls, as the theme for the party was “Wild Wild West,” while the second-years all wore formal suits and dresses. The ceremony was kicked off with a cake-cutting ritual by the class representatives of second-year IB. Each of the second-year IB students was presented with an award made for him or her by the 11th graders as well as a momentum by the school. For example, one particularly diligent and intelligent student received the award “Mr. Genius,” while another one fluent in the English language and quite an excellent orator was given the title “Mr. Shakespeare.” One who was an excellent football player was named “Mr. Beckham, while one enthusiastic girl became “Ms. Bubbly.” Some of the students came up and gave speeches about their experiences in CIRS. Two songs were sung in honor of the IB graduates, performed by the 11th and 12th graders. A presentation was also specially prepared for them, and it was quite a moving experience. Towards the end of the program, there was a special dance between randomly selected partners in second-year IB. Afterwards, there was a special dinner held in honor of the second-year IB. These achievers from second-year IB will be sorely missed.



IB 2nd Year Exams

Our 2nd year IB finished their finals on 19th November. After year long of hard work time finally came when they had to appear for their exams. Our students of 10th and 12th also appeared for their first pre-boards this month. After studying for a long time, finally the students finished their exams also on 23rd of November.



DIWALI

DIWALI CELEBRATIONS:

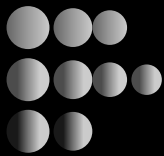
Diwali, or **Deepawali**, is a major Indian festive holiday, and a significant festival in Hinduism. Many legends are associated with Diwali. It is celebrated as the "**Festival of Light**," where the lights or lamps signify victory of good over the evil within every human being. The deity of wealth in Hinduism, Goddess Lakshmi is thanked on this day and everyone prays for a good year ahead.

In CIRS, this festival was celebrated with immense joy and happiness. Our day started with an invocation prayer to Goddess Lakshmi, followed by the most awaited competition, the rangoli competition-the competition of colours.

Later in the evening we had a special aarti performed in the honour of goddess Lakshmi. The whole school was lit by the diya's(Lamp). It looked like heaven on earth. The beauty was breathtaking.

Followed by the aarti we had the best time of our day. At night, we all assembled for the cracker bursting ceremony which was very beautiful and fun filled. This day taught us how good always triumphed over evil.



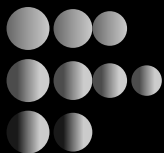


SAHODAYA



SAHODAYA

The school concentrates on an all-round development and performance of every child. Academics is not the only thing, Sports are a part and parcel of life. All work and no play makes jack a dull boy. CIRS conducted the 7th Sahodaya athletic meet where various schools participated. Our school participated and our boys and girls did a very good job. There were many races, relay, shot-put, javelin and many other sports events. We won many gold, silver, and bronze medals. Our school did exceedingly well and won the boy's championship and also the overall championship! The Sahodaya meet went on for 2 days. The Sahodaya meet was indeed very good organization which we have been conducting over the years. It is an honor for the school to be conducting the 7th annual athletic meet in our school.



CHILDRENS DAY

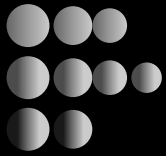


CHILDREN'S DAY

Children's Day is to celebrate "childhood". On Children's Day, tribute is paid to all children in the world. Children are loved by one and all. India's first Prime Minister, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, was born on November 14. After his death in 1963, his birthday has been celebrated as children's Day in India. Children's Day is not just a day to let the future generation have its say. It is a day to remember a leader who, in his quiet but determined way, laid the foundation to convert a nascent nation into a world power.

In CIRS, this day was celebrated with immense joy. Our teachers made sure that we had a wonderful time that day. Our teachers performed for us. Through their skit they taught us the importance of truth and also the importance of education. They performed a splendid musical round informing us about the various 'raagas'. They also danced and took us for a journey around our country with the help of "saree's". Our Principal Sir also took us over an emotional ride about the importance of childhood through a poem.

Last but not the least we all enjoyed the pamper and the grand food which we got that day.

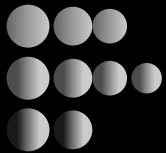


FINE ARTS WEEK



FINE ARTS WEEK

This is the first time that CIRS has celebrated fine arts week in the school. In this week our arts and music departments filled us with that information and told us about those facts which we were not aware of. They told us about the history of music and arts; they also depicted different kinds of paintings. There were musical presentations were the students performed on the stage through which they told us about different instruments and other musical forms. We also got the golden opportunity to witness one of the glorious events in the history of CIRS. We watched the splendid perforce on stage by our students were all three fields of arts were shown together, i.e music, dance and sketching all at once. This week not only the students performed but also the teachers performed with them. We leaned a lot from this week and we would like to thank our art and music departments for instilling in us the need and importance of these activities in our life.

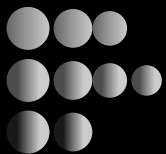


PRE - BOARDS



IPRE-BOARDS 10TH & 12TH

The out going classes of CIRS, of the year 2007-08 gave their first pre-boards which started from 16th November. This was just a stepping stone for them.

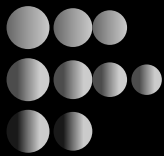


TAPOVAN AND GITA JAYANTHI



Tapovan and Gita Jayanthi

The day of October 21st, Wednesday, was the birthday of one of the most revered saints of modern times. Shri Param Pujya Gurudev Swami Tapovan Maharaj was born on this day, and would soon grow to bless humanity with his profound teachings of the subtle Vedantic truths. Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda described him as, “...unique in that in spite of his inordinate erudition and scholarship, deep devotion and highest spiritual realization, he chose to remain in his humble, mud-plastered one-room kutia with a small verandah at Uttarkashi...” Swami Chinmayananda, being a great Master himself, had utmost respect for his guru. Speaking of Tapovan Jayanthi, Swamiji said, “The birth of such a Master should be celebrated not with cheap tinsels and noisy crackers, high sounding talks or bell-ringing rituals. We must learn to lift our minds to meet Him where He is in our own hearts.” Incidentally, this day was also the day that the legendary Vedantic scripture, the Bhagavad-Gita, was born.



CYCLE RALLY



CYCLE RALLY

Water conservation is a very important matter which is in the highlight these days. Pure Water is not found in abundance and people are wasting water. Water conservation campaigns are very common these days. This is precisely the reason why NCC organized the campaign. The National Cadet Corps, the first year IB students and the children of the Duke of Edinburgh went on a cycle rally to spread the awareness on water conservation and its effects. We started our day by a prayer and then a speech on water conservation. We then started our cycle rally. Our destination was 22kms away from the school. We drove through 2 main areas where there was a lot of traffic jam. Each cycle had a placard in Tamil conveying the message of saving water. As the 70 students were riding the cycles magnificently all the people were staring at us as we were shouting, "SAVE WATER!!!". The rally was challenging, as there were many steep slopes and we had to maintain our speeds not confronting the person ahead or behind us. The rally was tiring but we had a different experience altogether.

This rally taught us the importance of water and also taught us a very important lesson, "NEVER WASTE WATER". Tired as we were, we all enjoyed thoroughly and had a wonderful experience.

